

# Browser Calling — Project Summary

What we built, why we built it, and what it means for the team

May 2025 | Internal — For Management Review

## The Problem We Solved

A recurring issue across our customer operations — particularly at airport pickups — is that customers arrive in New Zealand without a working phone number. They may have Wi-Fi on their phone (at the airport, or through the motorhome's onboard connection), but no way to make a voice call.

This left customers with no reliable way to reach us at one of the most stressful moments in their trip, and left our team receiving calls with no context about who was calling or which booking they were on.

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| <b>The gap</b> | Neither HubSpot nor Aircall support WhatsApp calling, and neither vendor has a timeline to add it. This was a long-standing pain point with no resolution from our existing platforms. |
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## What We Built

We built a lightweight browser-based calling solution that lets customers call us directly from their phone browser over Wi-Fi — no SIM card, no app, and no download required. The customer taps a link in their booking confirmation email and is connected to our team within seconds.

From the team's perspective, the call arrives in Aircall exactly like any other inbound call. The agent hears a spoken announcement before the customer connects telling them the customer's name and booking reference. After the call ends, it is automatically logged in HubSpot against the correct contact record, including a transcript of the conversation.

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|  <b>In plain terms</b> | A customer with no SIM taps a link → their browser calls us over Wi-Fi → the agent hears who's calling before answering → the call logs itself in HubSpot with a transcript. No manual steps required from the team. |
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## The Customer Experience

The customer journey is designed to be as simple as possible:

- Customer receives their booking confirmation email containing a 'Call us from your browser' button
- They tap the button on their phone — the page opens instantly in their browser
- The page shows 'Line open' with a large green call button
- They tap the button and the call connects within a few seconds
- If no one is available, they hear a message directing them to WhatsApp

The page works on any modern smartphone browser — Chrome, Safari, Firefox — and requires no app installation. It works on any Wi-Fi connection including airport Wi-Fi and the motorhome's onboard hotspot.

## The Team Experience

From the team's perspective:

- The call arrives in Aircall just like any other inbound call
- Before the call connects, the agent hears a brief spoken announcement: 'Wilderness browser call. Customer: Sarah Smith. Booking reference: BK105067. Connecting now.'
- The agent can greet the customer by name and pull up their booking immediately
- After the call ends, a Call activity is automatically created on the customer's HubSpot contact record — no manual logging required
- The HubSpot activity includes the call duration, outcome, booking reference, and a full transcript of the conversation



### Key improvement

Previously, browser calls arrived with no caller ID and no context. Agents had no idea who was calling. Now they know the customer's name and booking reference before they say hello.

## What Gets Logged in HubSpot

Every browser call automatically creates a Call activity on the customer's HubSpot contact record. The activity includes:

| What's recorded   | Example                      |
|-------------------|------------------------------|
| Call type         | Inbound Phone Call           |
| Call outcome      | Connected / No answer / Busy |
| Duration          | 3 minutes 42 seconds         |
| Booking reference | BK105067                     |
| Customer name     | Mark Lonergan                |

|                 |                                                                                                                                  |
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| Call transcript | [Customer] Hi, I've just landed and I'm not sure where to go. [Agent] No problem Mark, head to the ground floor arrivals area... |
| Associations    | Linked to both the HubSpot contact and the booking deal                                                                          |

The transcript typically appears on the HubSpot record within about a minute of the call ending. It labels each line as either [Customer] or [Agent] so the conversation is easy to follow.

## Cost

The solution uses Twilio, a cloud communications platform, on a pay-as-you-go basis. There is no monthly subscription or minimum commitment.

| Cost item                    | Estimated monthly cost (50 calls) |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Twilio phone number (NZ)     | ~NZD \$5/month                    |
| Per-call connection costs    | ~NZD \$15–25/month                |
| Transcription                | Included in Twilio account        |
| Google Apps Script (logging) | Free — part of Google Workspace   |
| Total                        | ~NZD \$20–30/month                |

At current expected volumes of under 50 calls per month, the total cost is approximately NZD \$20–30 per month — less than the cost of a single missed booking.

## What This Does Not Replace

This solution is purpose-built for one specific scenario: customers who have Wi-Fi but no working phone number. It is not a replacement for:

- Aircall — all calls still route through Aircall for the team to answer
- The main Wilderness phone number — customers with a working SIM should still call normally
- WhatsApp messaging — the call page includes a WhatsApp button as a fallback for customers who prefer to message
- HubSpot's existing call logging — Aircall's own integration with HubSpot continues to operate as normal for regular calls

## Ongoing Operation

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Once set up, the system is fully automated and requires no day-to-day management. The team does not need to do anything differently — calls arrive in Aircall as normal and HubSpot logs itself.

### Monitoring

A daily automated check runs every morning at 8am and sends an email alert if any calls in the previous 24 hours failed to log correctly in HubSpot. This means issues are caught and flagged before they accumulate.

### Maintenance

The solution runs on Twilio's infrastructure (no servers to maintain) and Google Apps Script (no hosting required). Ongoing costs are purely usage-based. The only regular maintenance task is rotating the security token periodically — a 5-minute task.

### Scalability

The architecture scales automatically with call volume. If airport pickup calls increase significantly, there is no infrastructure change required — Twilio handles the load and costs scale proportionally.

## Risks and Limitations

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| Risk                                 | Likelihood | Notes                                                                                                                  |
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| Airport Wi-Fi blocks the call        | Low        | Tested on standard Wi-Fi. Most networks support this. The motorhome's own hotspot is a reliable fallback.              |
| Customer doesn't see the link        | Medium     | Dependent on email open rates. The link should be prominent in the booking confirmation.                               |
| Call transcript quality              | Low        | Transcription is in English and handles NZ accents well in testing. Occasional words may be misrecognised.             |
| Twilio service outage                | Very low   | Twilio maintains 99.95% uptime SLA. An outage would only affect browser calls — regular calls unaffected.              |
| Monthly cost increases significantly | Low        | Only happens if call volumes increase substantially. Easily monitored and the daily alert would flag unusual activity. |

## What Could Come Next

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The current solution focuses on one-way calling — the customer calls us. A natural future enhancement would be the ability to call customers back via their browser, for situations where a customer contacts us about a motorhome issue on the road and doesn't have a working number for us to call.

A longer-term option, if HubSpot or Aircall ever adds WhatsApp calling support, would be to route these calls through WhatsApp instead — which would give customers a more familiar interface and allow two-way calling without any infrastructure on our side.

Neither of these is required now. The current solution addresses the core airport pickup problem effectively and at minimal cost.

## Summary

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| <b>In short</b> | For approximately NZD \$25 per month, customers arriving at the airport without a working SIM can now call us from their browser. Agents know who is calling before they answer. Every call is automatically logged in HubSpot with a transcript. The system runs itself and alerts us if anything goes wrong. |
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